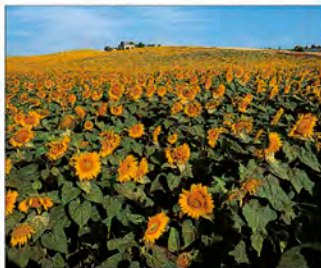


STEMS



Clever creature

This aphid knows just where to go for food supplies! It takes less than a second to pierce the soft part of the stem, which is full of nutritious sap.



Sun worshippers

The stems of sunflowers turn so their flowers can always face the sun.

This young tree is two years old.

Branches grow from the stem and hold the leaves out to the light.

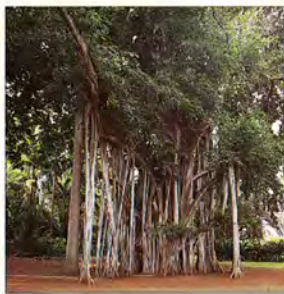
As the tree gets older and taller, the main stem will thicken to form a trunk.

Clinging on

In its rush toward the light, the sweet pea has no time to grow strong stems. Instead it uses twirling tendrils to wrap around other plants. They will support its fast climb to the top.

The widest spread on Earth

Just one banyan tree can make a forest! Their branches throw down special aerial roots. These grow into the ground and expand into trunks. A single tree in Kolkata, India, has more than 2,600 of these trunk look-alikes.



Water and minerals travel up the stem from the roots.